

F

FOR THE PAST two years, Hindustan Unilever Ltd (HUL) has gone to business schools specifically looking for graduates inclined towards digital commerce. That's nothing unusual, except that traditional sales and marketing functions have made way for new job descriptions. It indicates a changing India where many opportunities have forced

34 |

companies regardless of size to look for talent but with a difference, and this comes forth in the *BT-Taggd* survey of The Best Companies to Work For in India this year. Just what is the change? Today's talent—and there's plenty of that in India—is looking for a new set of challenges and new-age roles. For them, a sales and marketing job is passé. For instance, HUL has created the position of e-commerce manager. Large FMCG companies see around 10% of their revenues in the digital age coming from e-commerce channels, and even the most conservative estimates suggest the number could touch 30% by the end of the decade. Besides, every company recognises the need to have a closer look at their business. That has led to the creation of new positions, with clear job descriptions.

"All this is in line with the change we are bringing about in each of our

businesses," says Anuradha Razdan, Executive Director (HR) and CHRO, HUL & Unilever South Asia.

This process will test the mettle of the best companies as the workforce gets reoriented across levels.

REDEFINING ROLES

This change is recent. Around a decade ago, any large organisation had a defined set of positions. There was a CFO, a CHRO, a CMO, a COO and, of course, a CEO. "Today, a Chief Data Officer or a Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) are realities," says Aditya Narayan Mishra, MD & CEO of recruitment

JOBS ALERT

► **ORGANISATIONS ARE** redefining existing jobs and creating new ones in line with changing market dynamics

► **TALENT, TOO, IS** looking for a new set of challenges and companies have had to reorient

► **TRADITIONAL ROLES** like finance, sales and marketing are seeing multiple sub-specialisations

► **THE INCREASING** role of digitisation across sectors is considered one of the primary reasons for this change

and staffing services firm CIEL HR. Apart from talent wanting new-age roles, they also see the need to specialise in one area, he adds.

Earlier, only a CTO would suffice; but in several companies there is a need for a CISO as well. "In a lot of industries, data protection is an important piece and a part of the overall boardroom agenda. A generalist may not fit the bill here in an age of such a specialised need," explains Mishra.

Speaking of new-age sectors—such as companies in the tech space—finance is a key role. Mishra points out that these firms tend to have a Chief Accounting Officer as well as a CFO. "For these companies, fundraising is a big part of their overall business. A CFO may be very good with a treasury function, but this is a very different requirement."

Likewise, a CHRO is now complemented by a Chief Talent Officer, who looks after the employer brand and areas related to talent

